

Day 48 “偏见先行”——当想象取代真相

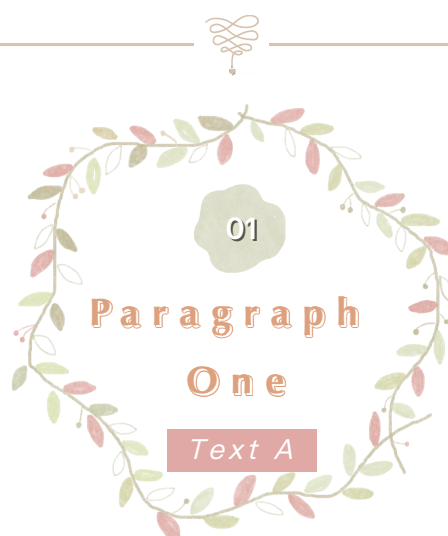
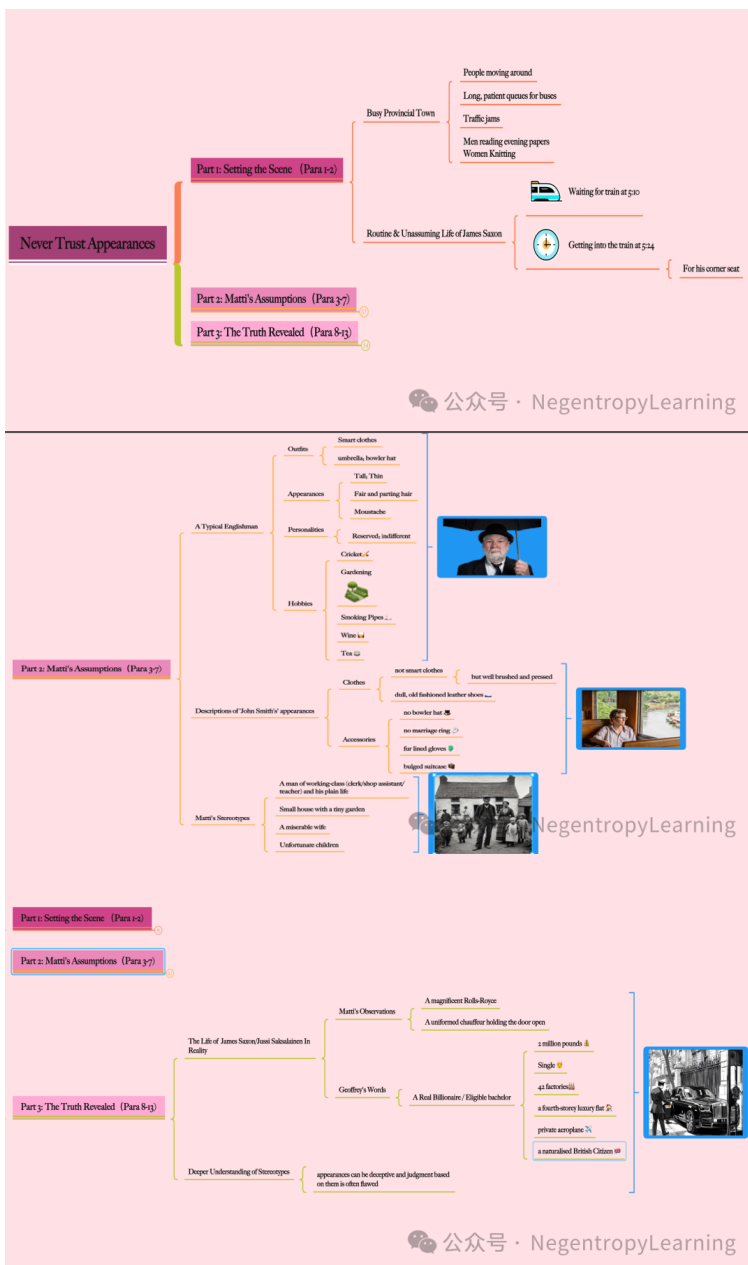
绒花儿 NegentropyLearning 2025年12月7日 20:00 四川



UNIT 5

Never Trust Appearance





✧ Sentence 1

Rush hour in a **provincial** town **is** certainly not so busy as in London, but even so there **are** plenty of people **moving about**.



#



Words

✧ **rush hour**: 交通高峰期，上下班高峰时间



✧ **provincial** [adj.]: 省的；地方的；眼界狭隘的，土气的（贬义，比喻“局限于地方” → 思想狭隘）

[SYN 1] regional; local; rural

[SYN 2] narrow-minded; short-sighted; unsophisticated;

✧ **move about**: 到处走动，四处活动

✧ Sentence 2

Long, patient queues **wait wearily** for buses.



#



Words

🌟 **wearily** [adv.] = in a tired, exhausted, or discouraged way 疲倦地；无力地；厌倦地；语气里常带着精力耗尽或心灰意冷的感觉，比 **tiredly** 更文学化。

⚠️ **be weary of sth** (both mentally and physically)

⚠️ **wear out**: 用坏，用旧（把东西磨损到不能再使用）| 使人筋疲力尽（把人“折腾累”）

⚠️ **weary vs dreary**

👉 **weary**: 人 / 身体 / 心情 → “累了、厌了”

e.g. I feel weary after a long day.

👉 **dreary**: 天气 / 环境 / 生活 → “又灰又闷、又长又无聊”

e.g. What a dreary Monday morning.

💡 **personification/alliteration**

🌟 **Sentence 3**

*Never-ending lines of cars **are checked** [主句1]
while red traffic lights **change** to green. [时间状语从句]*



#



🌟 **Be checked** (被动语态)

“被检查 / 被拦停 / 被控制”（这里是交警 or 信号灯系统等在管控）

🌟 **Sentence 4**

*Thousands of people **are packed** tightly in trains, (with) the men's faces
(being) buried in their evening papers
while women **try in vain** to **knit**.*



#



🌟 **pack** [v.] ① 打包；把.....装进包/箱 → pack a suitcase ② 挤满；塞满 [be packed with]

⚠️ pack vs crowd

pack (v.): 本义是“把东西塞进去 / 装进去”，引申为“挤满”。

👉 be packed with... = 被.....挤满（可用于人或物）

crowd (v./n.): 侧重“人很多、挤在一起”。

👉 The street is crowded with people.

🌟 bury one's head in: To look down at something and focus on it very intently, often ignoring everything else. 专注于

⚠️ To avoid facing a problem, pretend it doesn't exist, or refuse to deal with reality. “逃避现实”（固定搭配）

🌟 in vain: 徒劳地；白费地

🌟 knit [v.]: 编织（毛衣、围巾等）



一个典型的独立主格结构 (nominative absolute) 长这样：

名词 / 代词 + 分词 / 形容词 / 介词短语 / 不定式

关键有两点：

这个名词 / 代词不是主句的主语，而是这个“小结构自己”的主语（所以叫“独立”）

它和主句之间没有语法上的从属连词（没有 when / because / if 等），但在意义上有联系。

整个独立主格结构 → 在大句子里一般作“状语”。



独立主格的“小主语”和主句要有清晰的逻辑关系

常见关系：

时间 / 先后：When / After

原因：Because / Since

条件：If

伴随 / 情景：With... / While...

写的时候，脑中可以先用“从句”想一遍，看逻辑是否说得通。

例：

The homework finished, she went out. ≈ After she finished her homework, she went out.

His hands trembling, he opened the letter. ≈ As his hands were trembling, he opened the letter.

❌ 如果你不能顺利扩展成一个“主语 + be + ...”或“when/after/as...”从句，多半哪里有问题。

✧ Sentence 5

In a slow train it **may well be** an hour's journey to their station.

#



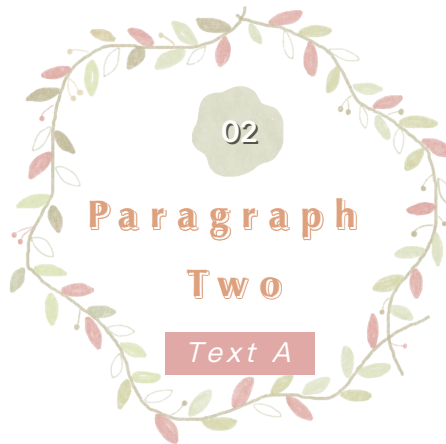
🌟 may well do sth= 很可能 / 大有可能 / 完全可以想象

这里 may well be 不是委婉，而是：

👉 从“慢车”这个事实推断：完全有理由说要坐一个小时。

⚠️ might as well = “不如……”、“干脆……算了”（表达一种“虽然不完美，但也没更好选择”的建议）

e.g. We might as well take the slow train.



🌟 Sentence 1

James Saxon **is** in his usual comfortable corner, quietly smoking a cigarette.



#

🌟 Sentence 2

When he **is travelling** by train at this time, [时间状语从句]
he always **reaches** the station at ten past five by the station clock, [主句1]
but he never **catches** the 5:14 train. [主句2]



#



Grammar

Reading Time

1. Using numbers (digital style)
2. Using past and to
From 0 to 30 minutes, we use past ("after" the hour).
From 31 to 59 minutes, we use to ("before" the next hour)
3. Special expressions
half past; o'clock; a quarter past; a quarter to



Sentence 3

Instead he **travels** by the train [主句1]
which **leaves** at twenty-four minutes past five [定语从句]
so as to be sure of getting his corner seat. [目的状语]



#



Words

🌟 **so as to** = in order to do sth “为了…… / 以便……”

⚠️ 否定形式: so as not to

[SYN] so that + 句子

e.g.

He got up early so that he could catch the first train.

他早起，以便能够赶上第一班火车。

I'll speak more slowly so that everyone can understand.

我会说慢一点，为了让大家都听得懂。

✧ Sentence 4

There **are** no first-class **compartments** or **reserved** seats on this train.



#



Words

✧ **compartment** [n.]: (火车、飞机等的) 包间, 隔间

✧ **reserved** [adj.]: 已预订的, 预留的; 矜持的, 内向的 (性格)

✧ Sentence 5

He **appears to be absorbed** in the sports news on the back page of his paper and **ignores the hurrying crowds**.



#



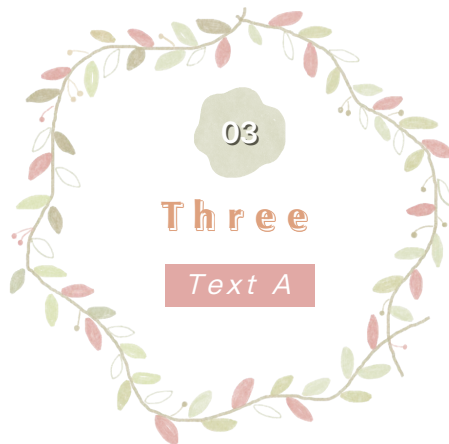
Words

✧ **absorbed** [adj.]: 全神贯注的; 专心致志的 (= deeply interested / engaged)

[SYN] be engrossed in/be immersed in/be preoccupied with/be fixated on/be obsessed with/be riveted by or to/bury one's head in

✧ **hurrying crowd**: 匆忙的人群 / 行色匆匆的人群





✦ Sentence 1

Facing him this evening there *is* a *Finnish* youth of eighteen, Matti Arvola.



#



🌟 **Finnish** [adj.]: 芬兰的; 芬兰人; 芬兰语 🇫🇮 Finland

👉 Finland is a Nordic country in Northern Europe, famous for its thousands of lakes, vast forests, and clean air. Its capital city is Helsinki, which lies by the Baltic Sea. Finland is known for its high-quality education system, advanced technology, and strong social welfare. The country has long, dark winters and short but beautiful summers with “white nights,” when it hardly gets dark. Finns are often described as quiet but friendly, and they value nature, honesty, and personal space. Finland is also the home of the sauna, which is an important part of everyday life and culture.



说“人” ➡ a Finn / Finns

说“国家、语言、文化等” ➡ Finnish



🌟 Sentence 2

*This **is** his first visit to England,* [主句1]

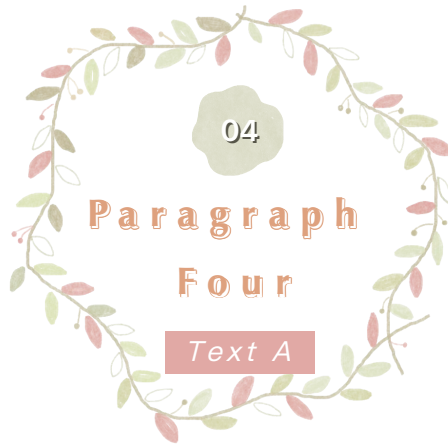
*though he already **knows** Geoffrey, the eldest son of the Jackson family,* [让步状语从句]

*with whom he **is going to stay**.* [定语从句]



#





✧ Sentence 1

As there **are** several people standing, [原因状语从句]
James Saxon **is** the only person [主句]
(whom/that) he **can see** clearly. [定语从句]



✧ Sentence 2

Matti **decides** [主句1]
that he **is** probably a **typical** Englishman, [宾语从句]
and he **observes** James carefully. [主句2]



🌟 **typical** [adj.]:

① 典型的，有代表性的

a typical mistake / a typical day

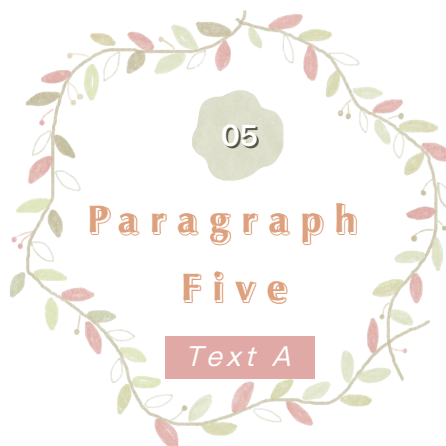
② 一贯的，平常的，特有的

His behavior is typical of him.

It is typical of him to be late.

③ (口语，抱怨) 真不像话，太典型了

He's late again—Typical!



🌟 **Sentence 1**

"Can he really **be** typical?" he **thinks**.



🌟 **Sentence 2**

"He **has** an umbrella, **neatly** rolled, but no **bowler hat**; in fact, no hat at all.





★ **neatly** [adv.]: 整齐地，有条理地；干净利落地，熟练地；巧妙地，恰到好处地（常用于抽象事物）

★ **bowler hat**: 圆顶硬礼帽（英国绅士常戴的一种硬毡帽）



★ **Sentence 3**

Of course, he **is reading** about **cricket** and he **is reserved** and not interested in other people.



#



🌟 **cricket** [n.]: 板球（运动）；蟋蟀（昆虫）

⚠️ That's not cricket.= That's not fair / not honest.



🌟 **reserved** [adj.]: 已预订的，预留的；矜持的，内向的（性格）

🌟 Sentence 4

But he **is** only of average **height** and his hair **is** not **fair**, but as dark as that of an Italian, and curly, with almost no **parting**.



#



Words

🌟 **height** [n.]: 高度，身高

🌟 **fair** [adj.]: 相当大的 / 尚可的；白皙的；晴朗的；浅色的

🌟 **parting** [n.]: 告别，离别；头发的分缝，发缝

🌟 Sentence 5

He **is not smoking** a pipe, and [主句1]
although we foreigners **think** [让步状语从句]
that a real Englishman **ought to have** a **moustache**, [宾语从句]
he **is** clean-shaven. [主句2]



#



🌟 **ought to** 应该；语气稍正式/严肃，强调“道德义务”或“合理期待”

⚠️ 否定：ought not to / oughtn't to

🌟 **moustache**[n.]: 山羊胡



moustache: 在嘴巴上面

beard: 在下巴和脸颊这一圈

🌟 **clean-shaven**: 刮得干干净净的；没有胡子的

🌟 Sentence 6

His nose **is slightly crooked**.



#



🌟 **slightly** [adv.]: 稍微地；轻微地

🌟 **crooked** [adj.]: 弯曲的，不直的

🌟 Sentence 7

What a serious face he **has**!



#



Grammar

感叹句：

- ① What + (a/an) + adj. + n. (+ 主语 + 谓语)
- ② How + adj./adv. (+ 主语 + 谓语)



感叹句里后半部分还是陈述语序，不倒装

It is so beautiful. → How beautiful it is!

It is such a beautiful day. → What a beautiful day (it is)!

✧ Sentence 8

He **is frowning** a little, but the eyes beneath his **worried-
looking** forehead **are** sincere and honest.



#



Words

🌟 **frown** [v.]: 皱眉；蹙眉（表示不满、疑惑、担忧等）

⚠️ frown at sb/sth (对.....皱眉) | frown on/upon sth (习语：不赞成)

🌟 **worried- looking** [adj.]: 样子显得很担心的；看上去忧虑的

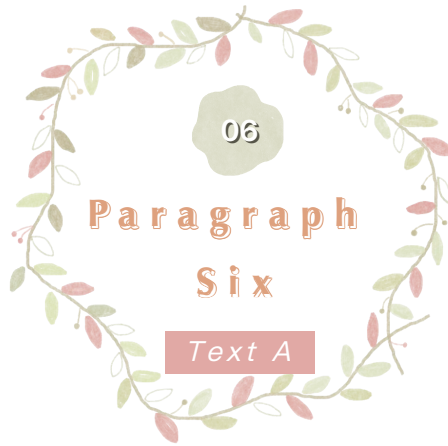
✧ Sentence 9

I **don't think** [主句]
he **is** intelligent [宾语从句].



#





✧ Sentence 1

His clothes **are anything but** smart.



#



✧ anything but = “in no way / not at all” 绝不是；根本不是；一点也不

⚠ nothing but = 只有……，只是……而已（肯定某一点）

✧ Sentence 2

In fact, they **are rather** old, though **well-brushed**.



#



🌟 **rather** [adv.] 程度副词：相当，颇为，有点儿 (= quite / fairly)

[SYN] very; really; so; quite; pretty; rather; fairly; extremely; incredibly; terribly; awfully; absolutely; completely; totally; entirely; utterly

🌟 **well-brushed**: 梳理得很整齐的；刷得干净的；用来形容头发、衣物或表面经过整理后“干净、整齐”

🌟 **Sentence 3**

Even though he **is not wearing** a wedding ring, [让步状语从句]
he **is** probably married, with perhaps three children. [主句]



#

🌟 **Sentence 4**

His gloves **are fur-lined** and his trousers (are) **well pressed**.



#



🌟 **fur-lined**: 内衬毛皮的；带毛皮里子的

🌟 **well pressed**: 熨得很平整的；熨烫整齐的

🌟 **Sentence 5**

He **keeps far** too many things in his pockets, [主句1]
so his suit **looks** badly **out of shape**. [主句2]



#



★ **far** [adv.]: 程度上很大, 非常

① far + 比较级: 差得远

This one is far better.

② far + too / so / enough: 太.....了, 远远.....

It's far too expensive.

③ by far + 最高级 / 比较级: 最最....., 远远.....

She is by far the best.

⚠ far 一般只修饰“带比较意味的东西”

★ **out of shape**: (身体) 走样; 不健康; (物体) 变形, 不成形

★ **Sentence 6**

What **dull, old-fashioned** leather shoes he **is wearing**!



#



★ **dull** [adj.]: 无聊、乏味; 暗淡、沉闷; 愚钝

★ **old-fashioned** [adj.]: 老式的; 过时的

[SYN] obsolete; outdated; archaic; out of date; passé

★ **Sentence 7**

His briefcase **is** old too and **bulging**, [主句]
so that the **zip-fastener does not close properly**. [结果状语从句]



#



Words

★ **bulging** [adj.]: 鼓鼓的, 凸起的

★ **zip-fastener** [n.]: 拉链 (英式英语用法; 美式英语更常说 zipper)

★ **properly** [adv.]: 正确地, 合适地, 正常地; 像样地

★ Sentence 8

There **are** the **initials** J. S. on it.



#



Words

★ **initial** [n.]: 首字母; 姓名的首字母缩写



initial [adj.]: 最初的, 起始的

his initial reaction 他的最初反应

initial [v.]: 在文件上签上姓名首字母

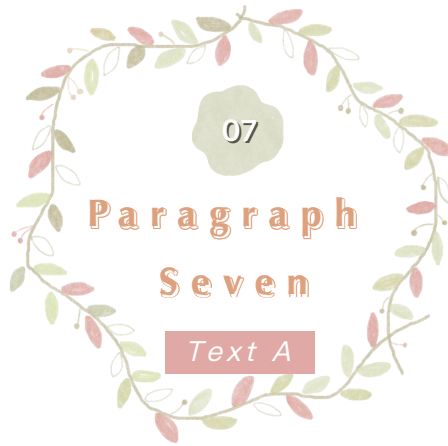
★ Sentence 9

Is his name John Smith?



#





✦ Sentence 1

I **think**[主句]

he **is** probably an office clerk or a shop assistant. [宾语从句]



#

✦ Sentence 2

Does he **look like** a teacher, though?



#



though 放在句尾时，通常不引导从句，而是做“语气副词”，表示“不过、然而”。

My neighbour told me I've got bad brains

But I'm alright though

Yeah we'll be alright though

Cause we're the kings and the queens of the new
broken scene

We'll be alright though

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✧ Sentence 3

*Anyway, he **lives with** a **plain** wife and five children in a small worker's house with a tiny garden, [主句]
where he **spends** his leisure time digging and weeding and mowing the lawn, or painting the **tool shed**. [定语从句]*



#



Words

✧ **Anyway** [adv.]: 总之; 不管怎样; 反正

✧ **plain** [adj.]: 简单的; 朴素的; 相貌平平的; 坦白的

✧ **leisure** [n.]: 闲暇; 空闲时间

✧ **shed** [n.]: 简易小屋; 棚屋; 储物间

⚠ [v.] 流(泪); 脱落; 去除; 摆脱, 去掉(多余的东西); 散发/发出(光/热/影响等)

⚠ shed light on sth. (固定表达) = 为.....提供线索 / 使.....更清楚

✧ Sentence 4

*But tonight, first he **is helping** his wife to put the children to bed [主句1]
and then he **is taking** her to the cinema [主句2]
as this **is** payday. [原因状语从句]*



#

✧ Sentence 5

*Or **is** he **visiting** the local pub?*



#

✧ Sentence 6

*Does he **drink** whisky (I **believe** most Englishmen do) or **does** he **prefer** beer?*



#

✧ Sentence 7

I **am** sure [主句]
he very much **likes** a cup of tea. [宾语从句]



#

✧ Sentence 8

He **seems** quite energetic, but his **complexion is** pale and he **is** very thin.



#



✧ **complexion** [n.]:

- ① 肤色 / 面色 / 气色 (最常见意义)
- ② 抽象义: 局面、性质、形势

e.g.

The election changed the complexion of local politics.

这次选举改变了当地政治的整体面貌。

✧ Sentence 9

*Does he **find** it difficult to satisfy the needs of his **miserable** wife and seven unfortunate children?*



#



Words

🌟 **miserable** [adj.]: 痛苦的, 悲惨的 (形容人的感受)

💡 Sentence 10

*Poor fellow! I **am** sorry for him."*

#



08

Paragraph Eight

Text A

💡 Sentence 1

*At last, shortly after a quarter past six by Matti's watch, [时间状语]
the train **reaches** Lakewell **Junction**, [主句1]
and Matti immediately **sees** Geoffrey waiting for him.[主句2]*

#





🌟 **junction** [n.]:

- ① 一般义：交叉点；汇合处；连接点
- ② 铁路中：火车交汇站 / 枢纽站

🌟 **Sentence 2**

They **greet** each other.



🌟 **Sentence 3**

At first Matti **cannot find** his ticket, but it **is discovered** in his bulging coat pocket.



🌟 **Sentence 4**

He **gives** it up to the ticket-collector and the two boys **go off** to find Geoffrey's father's car.



🌟 **give sth up** : 放弃某事[当宾语是代词时，必须放中间]；停止做某事；让出/交出（某物/位置）

🌟 **Sentence 5**

Near it [介词短语作地点状语]

there **stands** another car, a **magnificent Rolls-Royce**, [主句1]

and a handsome, **uniformed chauffeur is holding** the door open [主句2]

while James Saxon **steps** in. [时间状语从句]



#



🌟 **magnificent** [adj.]: 壮丽的；宏伟的；极好的（强调令人赞叹的美丽或伟大）

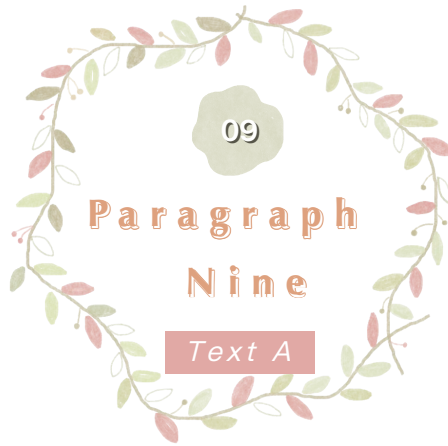
🌟 **uniformed** [adj.]: 穿制服的（通常指特定职业人员）

🌟 **chauffeur** [n.]: （受雇的）专职司机（尤指给富人或要人开车的人）



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✧ Sentence 1

"Who **is** that?" Matti **asks**.



✧ Sentence 2

"Why **is he getting into** that car?"



✧ Sentence 3

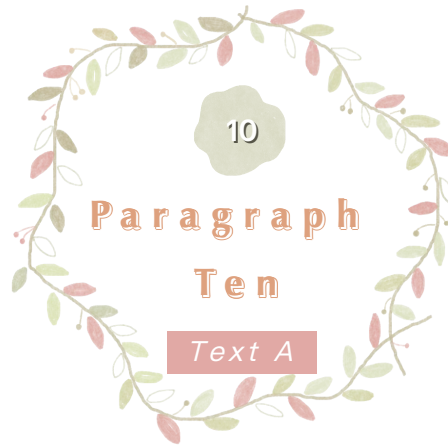
Where **does** he **live**?



✧ Sentence 4

He **looks like** a poorly-paid clerk or a workman."



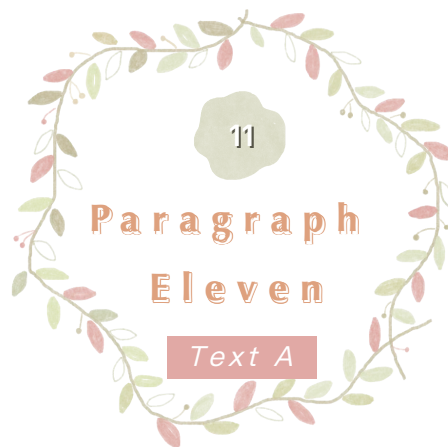


✦ ✦ Sentence 1 ●

Geoffrey **laughs** loudly [主句]
as if this **is** a good joke. [方式状语从句]



●



✦ ✦ Sentence 1 ●

"That **is** Sir James Saxon," he **replies**.



●

✧ Sentence 2

He **has** a fortune of around two million pounds, and **controls** forty-two factories in this area alone.



#

✧ Sentence 3

He **is** a bachelor [主句1]
who **lives** in a fourth-storey luxury flat, [定语从句]
so,
if he **feels like** it, [条件状语从句]
he **can go off** to the Riviera for a month or two. [主句2]



#



🌟 **bachelor** [n.]: 单身汉；未婚男子；学士（学位）

🌟 **storey** [n.]: （美式拼写：story）（建筑的）层，楼层

🌟 **the Riviera** = a famous, sunny, luxury holiday coast on the Mediterranean, especially in the south of France. 里维埃拉：地中海边一个阳光明媚、非常奢华有名的度假海岸。

⚠️ **Bay of Naples vs Riviera**

它俩都在地中海世界，都可以是“欧洲人梦想中的度假胜地”；

但 Bay of Naples 是一个具体的湾，the Riviera 是一整段著名度假海岸，更像一个“地区名/风格名”。



🌟 **Sentence 4**

Next week he **is flying** to Japan on business in his private **aeroplane**, [主句]
though people **say** he very much **prefers** travelling by train. [让步状语从句]

#



🌟 **aeroplane** [n.] 飞机（英式英语用词）

🌟 **Sentence 5**

He **is said** to have twenty-one suits, but he **is** always **seen** in the same old one.



#

✧ Sentence 6

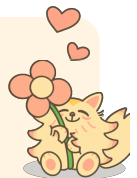
By the way, I **remember** now.



#

✧ Sentence 7

His father and mother **are** both Finns: Perhaps that **is** why he **takes** no interest in cricket.



#

✧ Sentence 8

His real name **is** Jussi Saksalainen, but he **is** now a **naturalised** British subject with an English name.



#



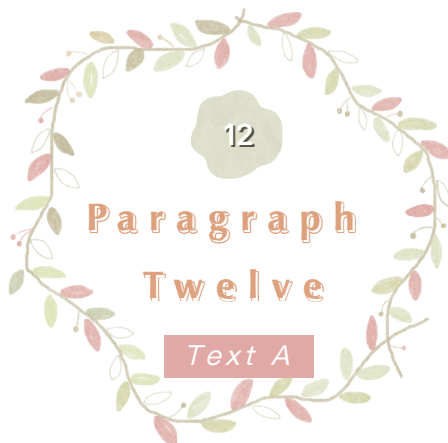
🌟 **naturalised** [adj.]: 归化的; 入籍的[指原本是外国人, 后来通过法律手续取得某国国籍。]

✧ Sentence 9

He **doesn't look** at all Finnish.



#



✦ **Sentence 1** ●

"Here'**s** your other case.



#

✦ **Sentence 2** ●

Put it down a minute while I **unlock** the car.



#

✦ **Sentence 3** ●

Do you **enjoy** gardening?



#

✧ Sentence 4

If so, you **can help** me: digging, weeding and mowing the lawn.



#

✧ Sentence 5

And I'm **painting** the tool shed tomorrow.



#

✧ Sentence 6

You **don't know** [主句1]
how to play cricket yet, [宾语]
but I'm **taking** you to a match on Saturday. [主句2]



#

✧ Sentence 7

Can you **speak** English any better now?



#

✧ Sentence 8

You **can soon lose** that Finnish reserve.



#

✧ Sentence 9

Come along!



#

✧ Sentence 10

Let's get going!



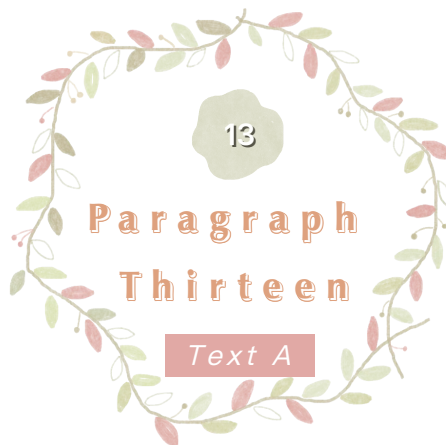
#

✧ Sentence 11

I'm hungry and hot."



#



✧ Sentence 1

Matti remembers sadly [主句]

all that his school-teachers say about his overactive and unreliable imagination.
[定语从句]



✧ Sentence 2

Perhaps they *are* right after all.



► Irony:

How does Geoffrey's explanation overturn Matti's earlier "story"?

Compare Matti's fantasy in para. 5–7 with Geoffrey's facts in para. 11:

Matti's assumptions:

He is "probably a typical Englishman."

Maybe an office clerk / shop assistant / teacher. "He lives with a plain wife and five / seven children."

Lives in a small worker's house with a tiny garden.

Spends his free time digging, weeding, mowing the lawn, painting the tool shed.

Drinks whisky or beer, has money problems, "Poor fellow! I am sorry for him."

Geoffrey's corrections:

He is Sir James Saxon — a rich industrialist, not a poor clerk.

He is a bachelor, no wife, no children.

Lives in a luxury flat on the fourth floor, not a small worker's house.

Can fly to the Riviera or Japan in a private plane.

Has twenty-one suits, though he chooses to wear the same shabby one.

👉 Geoffrey's speech systematically destroys each part of Matti's fantasy, showing how unreliable Matti's assumptions are when they are based only on outward appearance.

► **Extra Irony: Geoffrey also makes assumptions about Matti.**

Right after exposing Matti's false picture of James, Geoffrey himself starts making cheerful assumptions about Matti:

These are exactly the activities Matti had imagined for James Saxon's "plain, poorly paid" family life.

So there is a deeper irony:

Matti projects a whole "ordinary lower-middle-class life" onto James.

In fact, that "ordinary life" (gardening, mowing the lawn, painting the tool shed) will be Matti's own reality in Geoffrey's family.

Geoffrey doesn't realize this parallel, but the author lets us see it.



How does Matti finally see his own assumptions?

From the last paragraph, it shows that:

Matti now understands that his assumptions were not trustworthy. Geoffrey's explanation forces him to admit that his imagination, though vivid, leads him to distorted, incorrect judgments about people. The theme "Never Trust Appearances" is internalized: Matti realizes he has judged a man's class, job, family, personality, nationality almost entirely by clothes and posture.



-The End-